

Cancer Statistics Digest

Incidence rate for breast cancer in Japanese in Japan and in the United States from the Cancer Incidence in Five Continents

In order to make a comparison of breast cancer incidence rates between Japanese in Japan and those in the USA, we abstracted the age-standardized incidence rates (ASRs) from the *Cancer Incidence in Five Continents* Vol. I–X (CI5). The International Agency for Research on Cancer provides the CI5 databases on the incidence of cancer recorded by cancer registries (regional and national) worldwide. We used ASRs for Japanese from the following cancer registries: Miyagi, Nagasaki and Osaka in Japan, and California-Los Angeles, California-San Francisco and Hawaii in the USA from the CI5 database. Furthermore, we referred the ASRs in the USA (SEER 9 registries and Hawaii). Year at cancer diagnosis were from 1959 to 2007 in Vol. I–X in CI5; however, the years were a little different from cancer registries.

Figure 1 shows the ASRs for breast cancers coded as C50 (ICD10) for females. The ASRs in Japan were lower than those in the USA throughout the observation period. The ASRs of the three prefectures in Japan have been increasing. The ASRs in the USA also showed increasing trends, but several of them dropped in the latest volume (White in SEER 9 registries and Hawaii, and Japanese in Los Angeles and Hawaii). In earlier observation periods, Japanese in the USA had lower ASR than White and Black in the USA, but the ASRs of those populations seem to converge recently.

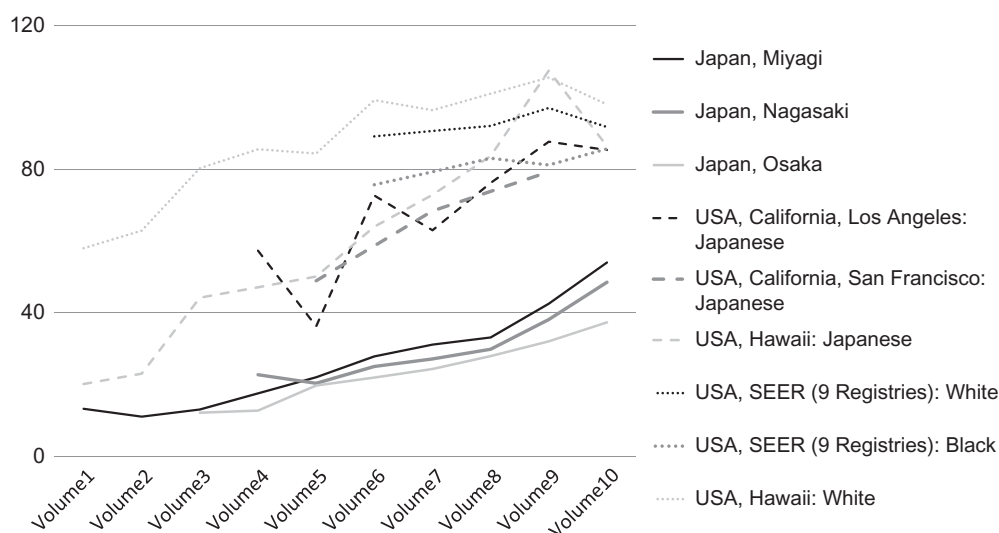


Figure 1. Age-standardized incidence rate for breast cancer (female).

Note: Data were downloaded from IARC CANCER Mondial Statistical Information System (<http://www-dep.iarc.fr/>). Responsibility for this presentation and interpretation lies with the authors of this article.

Kota Katanoda and Megumi Hori

Center for Cancer Registries, Center for Cancer Control and Information Services, National Cancer Center